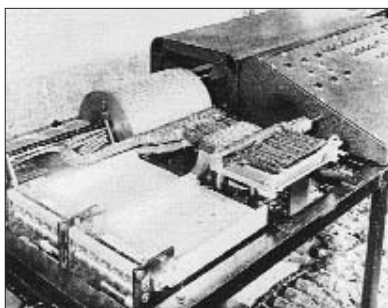


In other words, the first computer.

Debate rages as to which computer deserves to be called “The First Computer,” but it’s an idle one—because it’s only a title, and a flip-pant one at that. The Harvard Mark I is one candidate; the ABC was never



The Atanasoff-Berry Computer

patented, but that is a candidate, too; and the ENIAC (which we’ll talk about soon) is another contender. But take a look at this, from Time Magazine, in regards to who built the first computer (our italics): “*Even the Germans made a stab at computing with Konrad Zuse’s Z electromechanical computers, the last of which was the first general-purpose computer controlled by a program.*” It sidelines the Z3 completely. Well, the site we cited earlier overdoes it by calling the Z3 “automatic” and “fully-functional,” but the Time article sidesteps the “general purpose.” Well, Time is an American publication, so it’s Americans all the way for them—take your pick! (Hint: if you play war games, your guess should be obvious.)



Konrad Zuse in 1992

However, Konrad Zuse’s son, Prof Horst Zuse, has a Web site: www.epemag.com/zuse/. It’s well worth a long look. (For example, Prof. Zuse points out that the ABC was a special purpose computer and was not freely programmable.)

The almost-definitive guide to all you need to know about Zuse is <http://ei.cs.vt.edu/~history/Zuse.html>.